FIT LADDER · THE UNIVERSAL ENVELOPE

Every split reads the same way

A slide that outgrows its box becomes several. Now it always becomes the same *shape*: a cover that carries the masthead, the body pages, and — only when earned — a dedicated insight.

Cover, body, insight

Cover →

Cover, body, insight

Cover — always. A masthead worth a lead-in

Body →

Cover, body, insight (cont.)

Body — the split content, heading repeated, `(cont.)` from the second on

Key insight →

Cover, body, insight (cont.)

Key insight — its own page, only when earned. The takeaway never shares a page

Below-note →

Cover, body, insight (cont.)

Below-note — the last body page, one size down

Two kinds of trailing material

A key insight is the run's takeaway

Two kinds of trailing material

A **key insight** is the run's takeaway — a whole page, centered, sized up

continues →

Two kinds of trailing material (cont.)

A **below-note** is a footnote of the content above it — the last body page, one size down

Before this, both shared one page →

Two kinds of trailing material (cont.)

Before this, both shared one page — the wrong call for a takeaway

Neither repeats per body page →

Two kinds of trailing material (cont.)

Neither repeats per body page — that duplication was the original bug

Launch readiness

fourteen checks before the gate

Signal intake wired →

Launch readiness

fourteen checks before the gate



Signal intake wired

Scoring model calibrated →

Launch readiness (cont.)

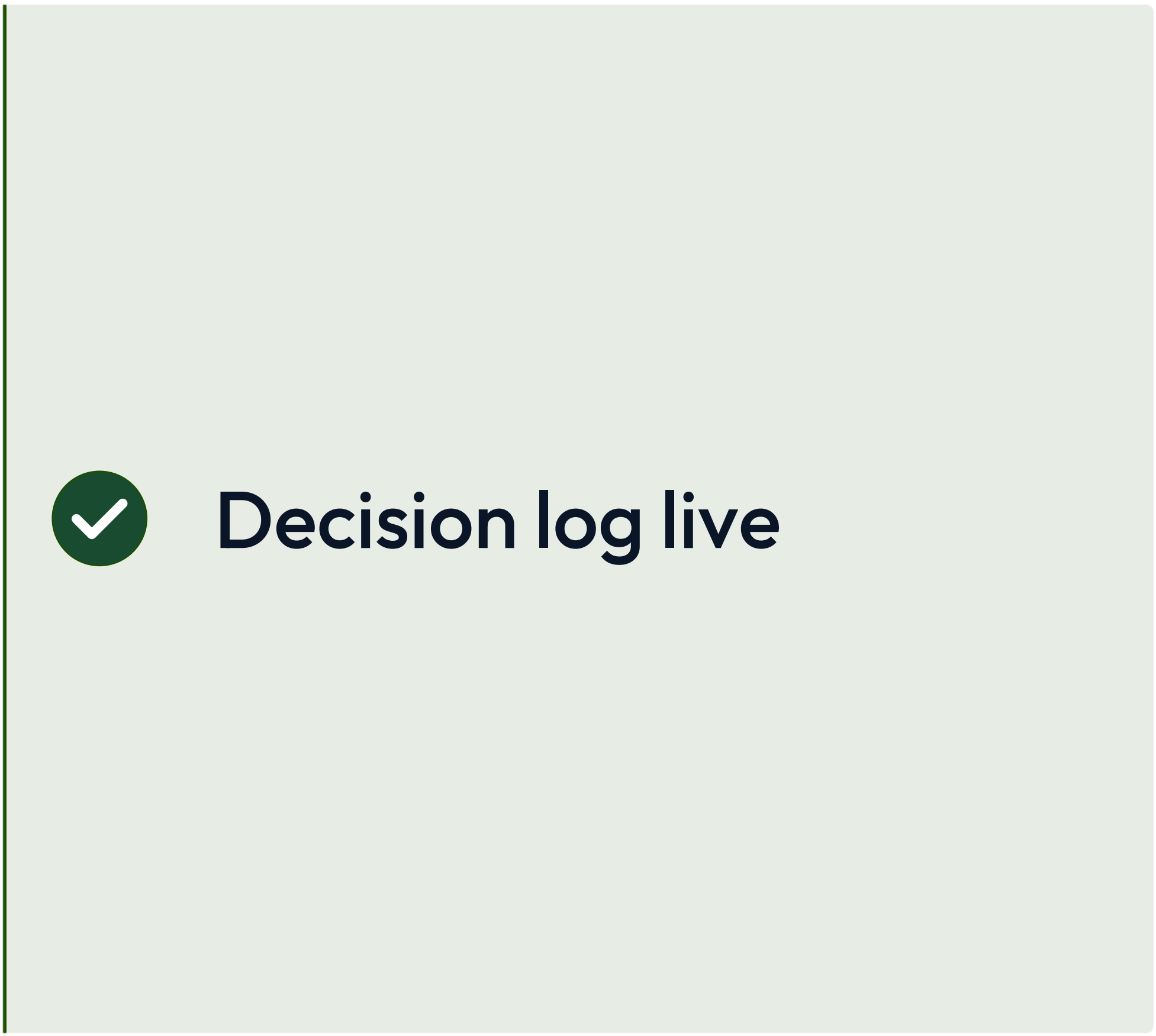
fourteen checks before the gate

Scoring model calibrated

Decision log live →

Launch readiness (cont.)

fourteen checks before the gate



Calibration loop running →

Launch readiness (cont.)

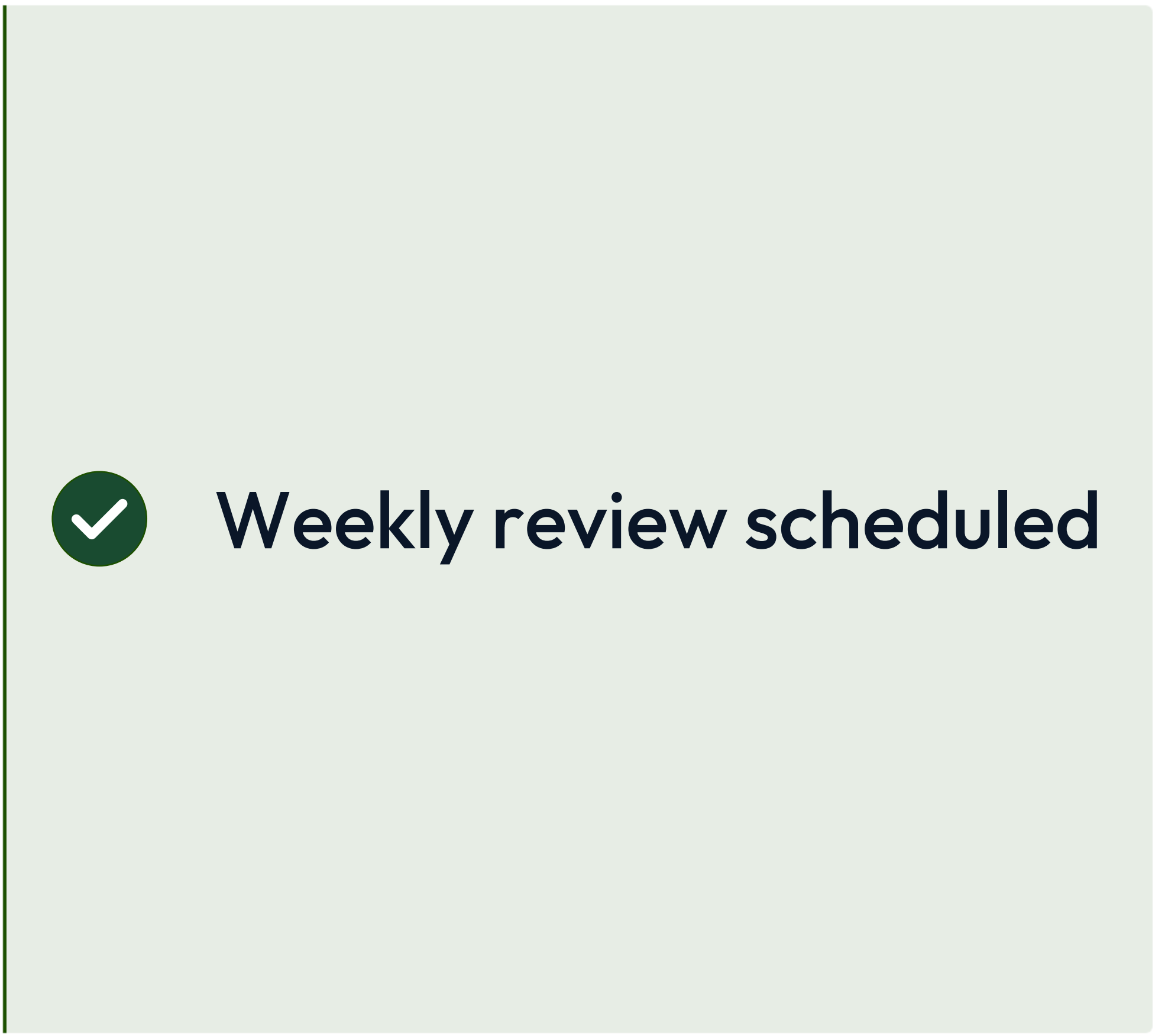
fourteen checks before the gate



Weekly review scheduled →

Launch readiness (cont.)

fourteen checks before the gate



Quarterly audit booked →

Launch readiness (cont.)

fourteen checks before the gate



Stakeholder map signed off →

Launch readiness (cont.)

fourteen checks before the gate

- [x] Stakeholder map signed off

Risk register populated →

Launch readiness (cont.)

fourteen checks before the gate

- [ ] Risk register populated

Budget tracker reconciled →

Launch readiness (cont.)

fourteen checks before the gate

- [ ] Budget tracker reconciled

Hiring plan approved →

Launch readiness (cont.)

fourteen checks before the gate

- [ ] Hiring plan approved

Roadmap published →

Launch readiness (cont.)

fourteen checks before the gate

- [ ] Roadmap published

Retrospective template ready →

Launch readiness (cont.)

fourteen checks before the gate

- [ ] Retrospective template ready

Metrics review automated →

Launch readiness (cont.)

fourteen checks before the gate

- [ ] Metrics review automated

Customer interviews booked →

Launch readiness (cont.)

fourteen checks before the gate

- [ ] Customer interviews booked

the key insight →

Launch readiness

fourteen checks before the gate

KEY INSIGHT

The gate is the list — nothing ships until every row is checked.

Source: the launch board, reviewed every Thursday.

Where the quarter went

spend against plan

Four programs carried the quarter; the rest were holding patterns.

Signal intake →

Where the quarter went

spend against plan

Signal intake

Rebuilt end to end; latency down from minutes to seconds.

Scoring model →

Where the quarter went (cont.)

spend against plan

Scoring model

Recalibrated on eighteen months of outcomes, then frozen.

Decision log →

Where the quarter went (cont.)

spend against plan

Decision log

Every call has a written owner, a date, and its evidence.

Calibration loop →

Where the quarter went (cont.)

spend against plan

Calibration loop

Weekly review closes the predicted-to-actual gap.

Partner onboarding →

Where the quarter went (cont.)

spend against plan

Partner onboarding

Two of five signed; three await our security review.

Audit readiness →

Where the quarter went (cont.)

spend against plan

Audit readiness

Evidence pack drafted, gaps listed, none signed yet.

the note →

Where the quarter went

spend against plan

The three unfunded programs are listed in the appendix, not here.

Build versus buy versus delay

The full comparison →

Cost

BUILD	High upfront, amortizes over years
BUY	Predictable subscription, scales with seats
DELAY	Zero now, compounds later

Speed

BUILD Slowest to first value

BUY Fastest to first value

DELAY Fastest of all, until it is not

Control

BUILD Full control of the roadmap

BUY Vendor roadmap, some influence

DELAY No roadmap at all

Risk

BUILD	Execution risk concentrated in-house
BUY	Vendor lock-in and pricing risk
DELAY	Deferred risk, often the worst kind

the key insight →

Build versus buy versus delay

KEY INSIGHT

The build option only pays off if we actually staff it — otherwise buy wins by default.

Source: vendor evaluation, Q3 procurement review.

Systems of record

what holds the truth

Customer identity →

Systems of record

what holds the truth

---

01 Customer identity.

The CRM is authoritative; every downstream system reads it and none writes back.

Billing and entitlement →

Systems of record (cont.)

what holds the truth

---

02 Billing and entitlement.

The ledger holds invoices, credits, and what a customer may actually use.

Product telemetry →

Systems of record (cont.)

what holds the truth

---

03 Product telemetry.

Warehouse-derived, rebuilt nightly, never treated as evidence on its own.

Risk register →

Systems of record (cont.)

what holds the truth

---

04 Risk register.

The board pack is authoritative — reviewed quarterly, versioned, signed by counsel.

The invariant

A run carries at most one cover

The invariant

A run carries **at most one** cover — and a title-less slide gets **none**, because a cover needs a heading. It still gets bodies and a closing page

continues →

The invariant (cont.)

The below-note and the key insight **close the run together**, on one page, at full size

continues →

The invariant (cont.)

A leading key insight rides the **cover**, so framing material is said once, first

Nothing is dropped →

The invariant (cont.)

Nothing is dropped: every page is the source slide with spans **removed**

One move, one shape

Cover, body, insight